



How To Ensure A Fast Start And A Strong Finish For Industrial Products

The opportunity to trim time and cost from a development project by starting with affordable off-the-shelf hardware can be tempting, especially for designers who are familiar with such platforms as Raspberry Pi and Arduino. Although these can be effective for proof-of-concept work, problems may arise when industrialising the end product to withstand the operating environment and satisfy mandatory requirements of the target market



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Small computer boards originally intended for educational use have been enthusiastically adopted for industrial applications. Although effective for fast proof-of-concept work, engineers need to consider how they will ultimately industrialise the finished product and port to a more suitable hardware platform at the earliest possible opportunity.

Hardware choices for speed and economy

Open source hardware is gaining recognition as an approach for building

cost-effective devices aimed at industrial and Internet of Things (IoT) applications. Organisations such as Open Source Hardware Association are promoting the cause and providing services such as certification to help users identify hardware that meets their criteria.

Among those companies that are positioning industrial devices such as human-machine interface (HMI) panels and programmable logic controllers (PLCs) based on open source hardware, some are basing their products on such platforms as Raspberry Pi and Arduino that were origi-

